



SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

Divyanshu: We all need to collaborate and share best practices

Collaboration between major players will determine the growth and future of the corporate ecosystem in sports, felt industry leaders during a panel discussion at PlayCom 2025: Business of Sports Summit at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi.

The session, titled 'Moneyball India – Where Capital Meets Competition', featured (from left to right) Satyam Trivedi (CEO, GMR Sports), Sanjay Adesara (CEO, Adani Sportsline), Divyanshu Singh (CEO, JSW Sports), and Uditvanu Das (Associate Vice President, Head of Sports, Havas Play India), moderated by Kala Anand, Director, Sports Advisory at KPMG India.

"This industry is at a juncture where we all need to collaborate, create value, and share best practices. There is growth that

happens because of being competitive," said Divyanshu.

Satyam broke down the profitability quotient in various sectors of the sports industry.

"Let's say when you talk about franchise or league-level investment, you go with a very long-term mindset because you know that it's going to take at least three to five years for you to break even. But manufacturing is very different from that. If you look at any property that we evaluate, financial discipline is key. That's, I think, the core of any investment that we look at because ultimately it's a business and it has to meet business sets," he explained.

Adesara stressed that sports remains an exception in the larger investment ecosystem. "In the 1980s, as economies opened up, industries accepted that heavy investments took two decades or more to yield

returns. By the 2000s, the horizon shrank to 10 years, and today, ventures are expected to show profits within three. Sports, however, remains a highly capital-intensive business. In sectors like ports, power, and cement, decades of sustained investment are understood before returns arrive. Yet, in sports, we are at a juncture where the country tries to replicate the success of one discipline across many others. That is the real problem."

Calling the sector still fairly nascent, Uditvanu pointed to the larger macroeconomic context. "We are at a per capita income of around \$2,800, similar to where China was in 2008. The moment we cross \$3,500-3,700 per capita income, the amount of extra money this economy will generate is going to be huge," he added.